



Youths For Green Action Kenya (YGAK)

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Greening Schools Initiative Report — Phase Three (Kakamega County)

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Executive Summary.

Between September and October 2025, Youths for Green Action Kenya (YGAK) successfully implemented the third phase of the *Greening Schools Initiative* in Kakamega Central Sub-County, Kakamega County.

A total of **30,000 tree seedlings** were distributed and planted across six schools as part of YGAK's broader mission to restore degraded landscapes, promote environmental awareness among learners, and advance climate action through school-based greening programs.

The species planted included **Cyprus**, **Grevillea**, and **Bischofia**, selected for their ecological value, adaptability, and contribution to sustainable school environments.

This phase further strengthened the link between education and environmental conservation, reinforcing YGAK's vision of empowering youth as key drivers of sustainable development and climate resilience.

Introduction.

Youths for Green Action Kenya (YGAK) is an environmental organization dedicated *to reforestation, conservation, Climate Action Championship and sustainable community engagement.*

The *Greening Schools Initiative (GSI)* aims to integrate tree planting and environmental education into learning institutions, transforming schools into living classrooms for sustainability and climate action.

This report documents the activities, outcomes, challenges, and recommendations from the Kakamega County phase conducted in October 2025.

Objectives of the Initiative.

- To increase tree cover through school-based reforestation programs.
 - To instill environmental stewardship and climate awareness among learners.
 - To strengthen partnerships between schools, communities, and environmental actors.
 - To support Kenya's broader climate action and reforestation goals.
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Seedling Distribution Data.

School Name	Sub-County	No. of Seedlings	Type of Seedlings	Date
Kakamega Primary & Junior Secondary School	Kakamega Central	5,000	Cyprus	9th Oct 2025
Rosterman Primary & Junior Secondary School	Kakamega Central	5,000	Cyprus	9th Oct 2025
Kakamega Boys High School	Kakamega Central	5,000	Grevillea, Cyprus, Bischofia	9th Oct 2025
Kakamega County Polytechnic	Kakamega Central	5,000	Cyprus	9th Oct 2025
Bishop Sulumeti Girls High School	Kakamega Central	5,000	Grevillea, Cyprus, Bischofia	9th Oct 2025
Bondeni Primary School	Kakamega Central	5,000	Cyprus	9th Oct 2025

Totals

- **Number of Schools: 6**
 - **Total Seedlings Distributed: 30,000**
 - **County Covered: Kakamega (Kakamega Central Sub-County)**
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Achievements.

- 30,000 seedlings distributed and planted in six learning institutions.
 - Integration of environmental learning into co-curricular programs and school clubs.
 - Strengthened collaboration among schools, YGAK, local administration, and community members.
 - Tangible contribution to Kenya's and global climate action and reforestation efforts.
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Rationale for Species Selection.

- **Cyprus:** Chosen for its adaptability, strong windbreak properties, and ability to thrive in diverse soil types — ideal for school compounds.
 - **Grevillea:** Selected for its agroforestry compatibility, soil fertility improvement, and shade provision.
 - **Bischofia:** Included for biodiversity enrichment and long-term tree cover contribution.
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Challenges Faced.

1. Administrative Protocols and Bureaucracy

The process of securing approvals and permissions in Kakamega posed challenges due to multiple administrative layers. After being referred to the County Director of Education under the Ministry of Education, the approval and clearance procedures took longer than expected, slightly delaying the start of the Greening Schools activities.

Recommendations & Next Steps.

1. Streamline Approval and Coordination Processes

Early engagement with county and sub-county education offices is essential to minimize bureaucratic delays. Since approval procedures vary across counties, YGAK recommends identifying and understanding specific administrative requirements before implementation.

2. Next County — Homa Bay

Building on lessons learned from Kakamega, the next phase in Homa Bay County will prioritize:

- Early coordination with education offices.
- Structured school engagement.
- Improved logistical and activity planning to ensure maximum participation and impact.

Impact Overview (2022–2025).

Since 2022, Youths for Green Action Kenya (YGAK), in partnership with **German Imaging Technologies (GIT)**, **The Design Gallery**, and **Victoria Furnitures Ltd**, has made remarkable progress through the **Greening Schools Initiative** and other community-based reforestation programs.

Together, we have successfully planted over **670,000 trees** across various counties in Kenya — including **Nairobi, Kiambu, Elgeyo Marakwet, Kakamega, Narok, Bungoma, Trans Nzoia, Kajiado, Uasin Gishu, Kisumu, and Mombasa**. These efforts have contributed significantly to ecosystem restoration, youth empowerment, and sustainable climate action at both local and national levels.

With the last phase of this year's edition set to take place in the third week of October in **Homa Bay County**, YGAK will reach an impressive milestone of **700,000 trees planted since 2022**. The **700,000 trees** planted by the end of 2025 represent **70% progress toward our shared vision of planting 1 million trees by 2027**, underscoring the tangible impact and consistency of this partnership.

Together with **German Imaging Technologies**, **The Design Gallery**, and **Victoria Furnitures Ltd**, our partnership remains steadfast in pursuing this collective goal — driving forward environmental restoration, climate resilience, and youth-led sustainability across Kenya.

Acknowledgment.

Youths for Green Action Kenya (YGAK) extends heartfelt appreciation to all participating schools, teachers, students, and community members in Kakamega County who contributed to the success of this phase.

Special thanks to our partners and sponsors — ***German Imaging Technologies (GIT), Design Gallery, and Victoria Furnitures Ltd*** — for their unwavering support of YGAK's environmental conservation, climate action, and reforestation initiatives across Kenya.

Their partnership continues to strengthen YGAK's mission to empower youth, restore ecosystems, and build sustainable communities for a greener future.

Conclusion.

The Kakamega phase of the ***Greening Schools Initiative*** marks another milestone in YGAK's ongoing journey toward a sustainable and climate-resilient Kenya.

Through school-based reforestation, environmental education, and youth empowerment, the initiative continues to nurture a generation that values nature and takes meaningful action for the planet.

The next phase — Homa Bay County — will build upon these achievements, ensuring that every school becomes a hub of environmental transformation and every learner a champion of climate action.
